

Role of Regulatory Focus in the Self-Efficacy–Creativity Relationship in Climbing

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1 INTRODUCTION

Regulatory Focus Theory (Higgins, 2012)

- **Promotion focus** → oriented toward gains and accomplishments;
- **Prevention focus** → oriented toward safety and avoiding losses.

Self-Efficacy in Climbing

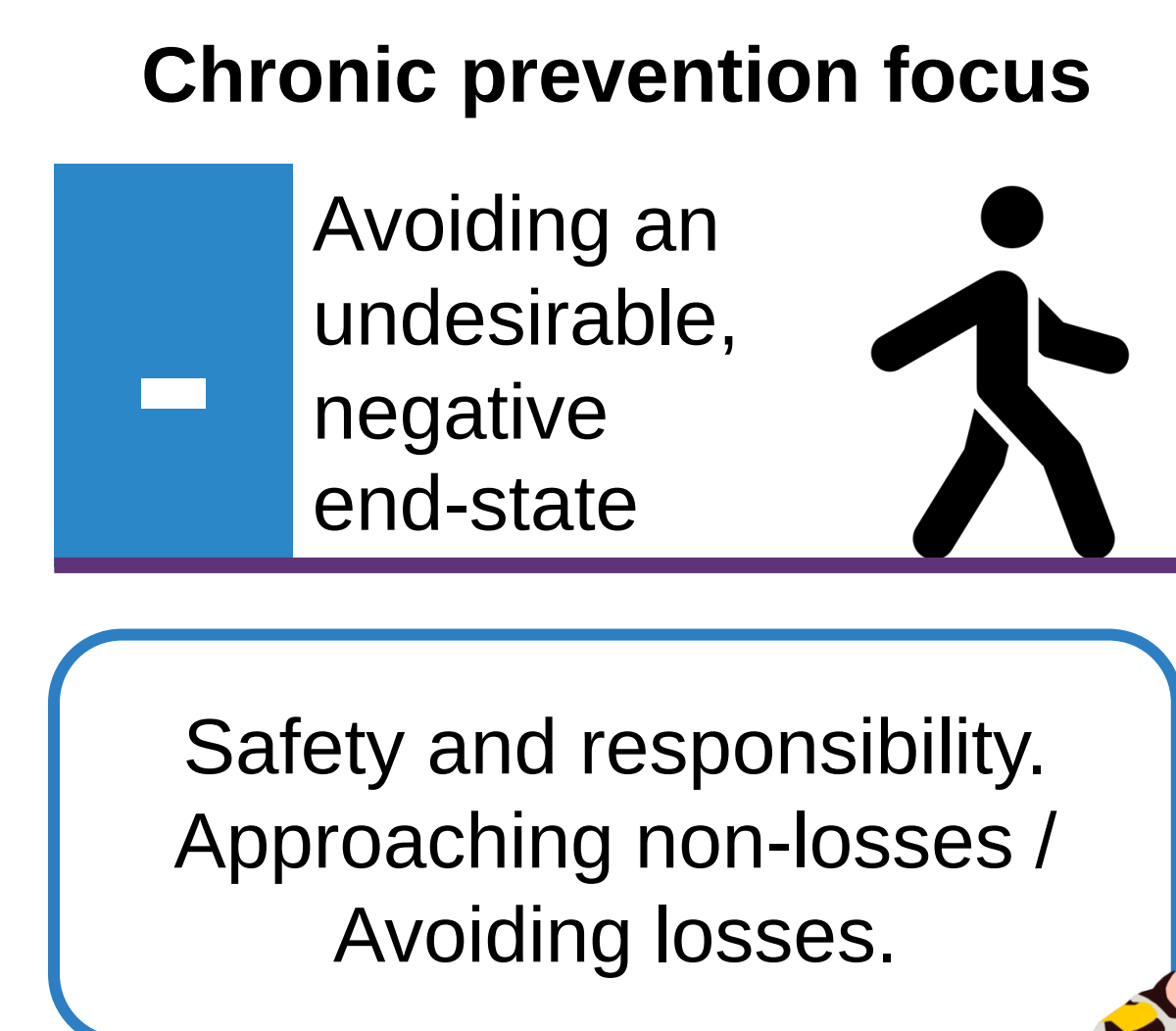
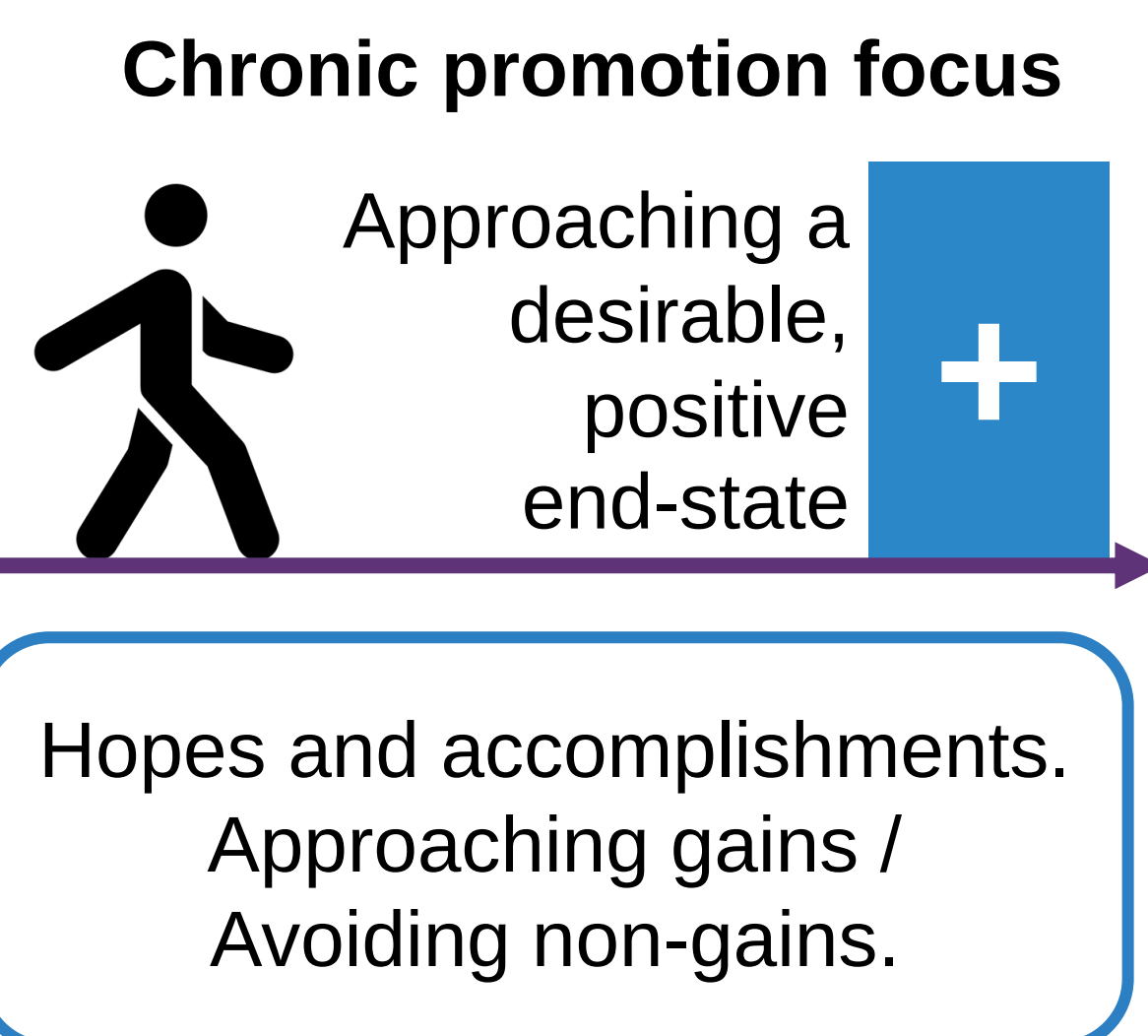
High self-efficacy → more likely to attempt difficult routes, take risks, and persist through challenges (Llewellyn et al. 2008).

Creativity in Climbing

Involves discovering novel movements, solving unique problems, and navigating routes efficiently (Künzell et al., 2021).

Purpose of the study

To examine whether **chronic regulatory focus** mediates the relationship between **self-efficacy** and **creativity** in climbers.



2 METHODS

Ninety-nine **climbers** (40 women); 34.28 years old (± 11.36 years); 12.25 years of experience (± 7.71 years); 27.3% were regular competitors.

A **survey** consisting of four parts:

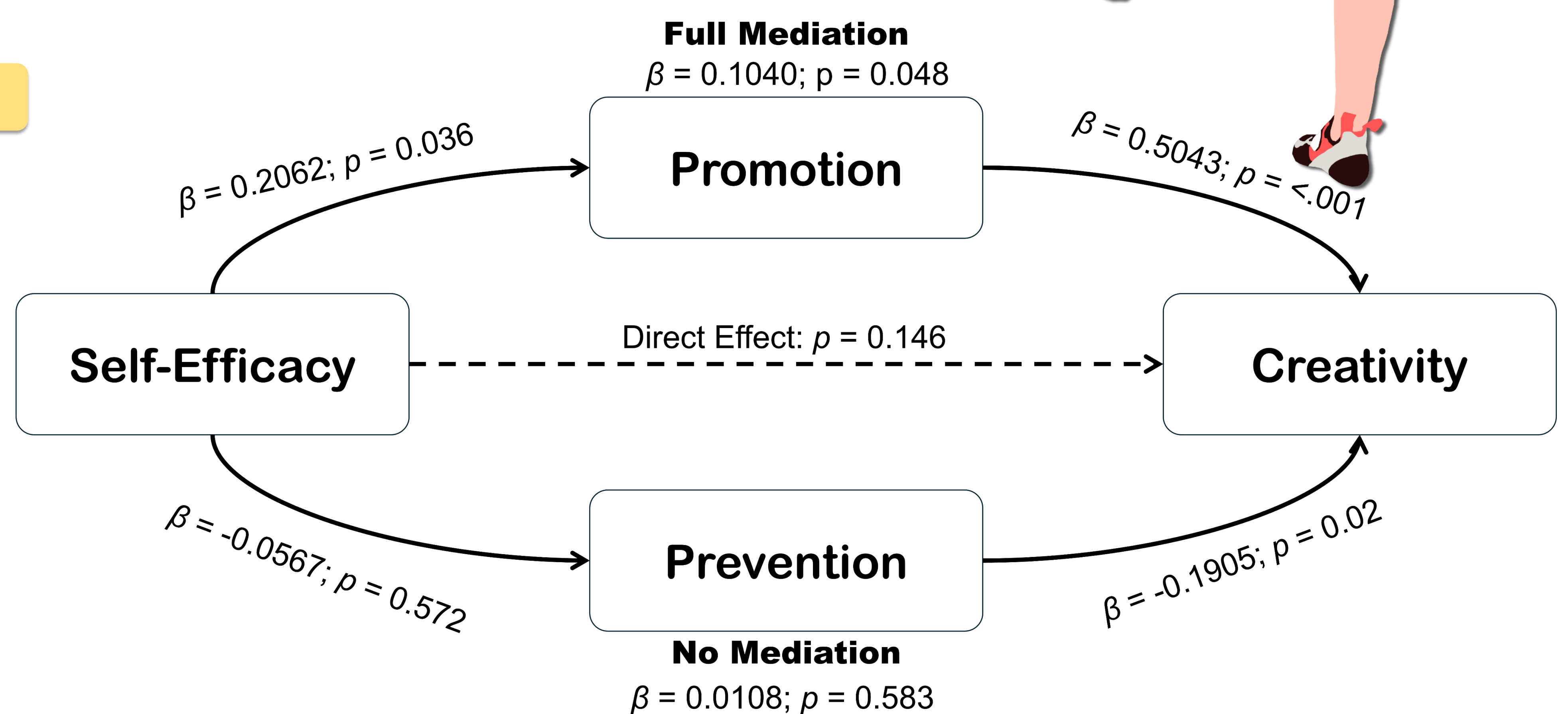
1. Demographics;
2. Modified Regulatory Focus Questionnaire (Semin et al., 2005);
3. Climbing Self-Efficacy Scale (Llewellyn et al., 2008);
4. Epstein Creativity Competencies Inventory for Individuals (Epstein et al., 2008).

3 RESULTS

Spearman's rank correlation coefficient

	1	2	3	4
1. Promotion	—			
2. Prevention	-0.225*	—		
3. Creativity	0.568***	-0.314**	—	
4. Self-efficacy	0.259**	-0.026	0.271**	—

Note. * $p < .05$, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$



4 DISCUSSION

Promotion focus is essential for creativity in climbers

- Self-efficacy *alone* does not lead to creativity → only climbers with high self-efficacy *and* high promotion focus showed increased creativity.

Prevention focus may hinder innovation in climbing

- An error-avoidant mindset was associated with low creativity → may limit adaptive problem-solving in dynamic, uncertain climbing environments.

Practical Implications

- **Training** should support not just skill, but also psychological dispositions that **foster creativity**.

References

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